



Jack Melnick

Senior Software Engineer | React · TypeScript · Node · Vue · Svelte

Remote · Massachusetts · Rhode Island · New Hampshire

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Senior Software Engineer with 20+ years building end-to-end web applications for startups to mid-size companies. Equally comfortable owning the front end, back end, and everything in between — from React and TypeScript UIs to Node.js and Python APIs, relational and graph databases, and cloud deployments. Thrives in early-stage environments where wearing multiple hats is the norm, and brings a design degree sensibility to every layer of the stack.

Remote-first. Based in MA/RI/NH.

Skills

Front-End: React 18+, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES2024+), Svelte, Vue 2/3, Angular, Tailwind CSS, SCSS, Storybook, Vite, Web Components, PWAs

Back-End & Databases: Node.js, Express, Python (FastAPI, Jupyter), Ruby on Rails, C#, Deno, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB, MongoDB, Graph Databases

Testing & Tooling: Vitest, Jest, Playwright, Web Vitals, Chrome Extension API, VS Code Extension API, Shell Scripts, 12-Factor App Methodology

Other: REST APIs, GraphQL, OpenAI API, Google Places API, Embeddings & Vector Similarity, HIPAA-compliant systems, Domain-Driven Design (DDD), MicroServices, Qlik Sense/View, Elastic Search, Apache Solr, Lucene

Current Work Experience

DownQuark (<https://www.downquark.work>)

Freelance / Contract Senior Software Developer

Jan 2018 ~ present

Provide end-to-end web and application development services as a solo developer, with a strong focus on early-stage and startup environments. Typical engagements span the full stack: requirements discovery, technical architecture, front-end implementation, back-end API development, database design, testing, and deployment for greenfield products, legacy refactors, and third-party API integrations.

Recent Projects

Many of the most recent projects are pre-launch startup products and are therefore covered by strict NDAs. I am happy to discuss in more detail, and can provide representative code samples or project summaries upon request.

Hightainment

Architected and built a next-generation entertainment review and content discovery platform targeting Gen Z and Millennial audiences across North America. The platform uses data-driven insights and curated recommendations to surface relevant movies, shows, and media experiences — eliminating the friction of endless browsing for users who value their time. Designed with a lifestyle brand sensibility, Hightainment extends beyond content discovery into community building, curated shopping recommendations, and cultural engagement around entertainment, food, and accessories.

AWS · C# · PostgreSQL · Python · Svelte · HTML · CSS · Jupyter Notebook · bash

DistillCloud

Architected and implemented a full-stack pipeline to retrieve pre-recorded meeting data (Zoom, Gong, etc.), generate custom prompts to analyze transcripts, detect high-level topics and granular points of interest, apply embeddings to determine cross-meeting similarities, and persist the highest-scoring matches to a PostgreSQL database. Transformed large volumes of unstructured meeting data into a queryable, team-scoped knowledge base with semantic search across arbitrary user-defined groups.

Python • C# • bash • TypeScript • Svelte • HTML • CSS • PostgreSQL

Previous Work Experience

PrepMD RMS — Senior Software Engineer (Nov 2021 ~ Oct 2025)

Led front-end architecture for a HIPAA-compliant telemedicine platform scaling from solo physicians to 2,000+ providers. Integrated an acquired overseas codebase (React + Vue) into a single codebase, reducing duplicated effort by 40%. Built UI/UX using Vue 2/3, Vite, React, React Native, Storybook, Ruby on Rails, Node, MySQL, and Chrome/VS Code extension APIs.

HTML5 • CSS3 • SCSS • JavaScript • TypeScript • Vue 2/3 • Vite • React • React Native • Storybook • Ruby • Rails • Node • MySQL • Chrome Extension API • VS Code Extension API

CarGurus — Senior JavaScript Engineer, DevX (Web) (Sep 2020 ~ Dec 2021)

Built custom tooling to enhance developer productivity across multiple teams. Created VS Code extensions, Chrome extensions, and shell scripts used by 80+ engineers. Worked with React, Storybook, Node, Web Components, PWAs, Freemarker, and various shell scripts.

HTML5 • CSS3 • SCSS • JavaScript • React • Storybook • Node • Chrome Extension API • VS Code Extension API • Web Components • PWAs • Freemarker • Shell Scripts

Madaket Health — Senior Software Engineer (Aug 2018 ~ Sep 2020)

Worked full-stack on an automation system using Domain-Driven Design (DDD) and microservices to simplify healthcare payer-provider transactions. Reduced processing time for eligibility checks by 30% through optimized API orchestration.

HTML5 • CSS3 • SCSS • JavaScript • Angular • Java • Freemarker • MySQL • Hibernate • DDD • MicroServices

Circulation, Inc — Senior Front End Developer (Nov 2017 ~ Aug 2018)

Led a 5-person front-end team from pre-MVP to launch for an on-demand ride-ordering solution integrated with Twilio, Lyft, and Uber across browser and mobile devices.

HTML5 • CSS3 • SCSS • JavaScript • React • React Native • Python3 • Meteor

Thinkful — Mentor (Oct 2015 ~ Apr 2018)

Mentored students in front-end programming and web design, covering HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, React, Redux, Node, and MongoDB.

HTML5 • CSS3 • SCSS • LESS • JavaScript • jQuery • Angular • React • Redux • Node • MongoDB

Bardess Group — Management and Technology Consultant (Oct 2016 ~ Oct 2017)

Integrated Qlik Sense and QlikView BI tools into web interface applications. Worked with Elastic Search, Apache Solr, and Lucene to improve data visualization performance.

HTML5 • CSS3 • SCSS • LESS • JavaScript • jQuery • React • Qlik Sense • QlikView • Elastic Search • Apache Solr • Apache Lucene

KleerMail — Web Developer (Jun 2015 ~ Aug 2016)

Sole front-end developer on the initial startup team, creating the MVP from scratch using Angular and Ruby on Rails.

HTML5 • CSS3 • SCSS • JavaScript • CoffeeScript • jQuery • Angular • Ruby on Rails

Shoebuy.com [shoes.com] — Web Developer (May 2014 ~ May 2015)

First in-house front-end developer; led a team that grew to 3 during a complete rebrand from shoebuy.com to shoes.com.

HTML5 • CSS3 • SCSS • JavaScript • jQuery • Backbone • Underscore • Handlebars • Java • Perl

Boathouse Group — Lead Web Developer (Apr 2012 ~ Apr 2014)

HTML5 • CSS3 • SCSS • JavaScript • jQuery • PHP • MySQL • ActionScript 2/3

Earlier Experience (2006–2012)

KHJ Brand Activation (Lead Developer), Createthe Group (Senior Presentation Layer Developer), Rockstar Games (Web Developer), Code and Theory (Web Developer), Domani Studios (Interactive Developer), BuzzBizz Studios (Print/Web Designer & Developer)

HTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery, PHP, MySQL, ActionScript 2/3, Perl, Java

Education

University of Florida — Gainesville, FL (2002–2004)

Santa Fe College — Gainesville, FL (2004–2006)

BuzzBizz.biz — Anchorage, AK (2006–2007)

First job out of school; when the startup dwindled from 5 people to 2, honed sales and client management skills while self-teaching solutions under pressure. This experience instilled the belief that with enough passion, anything can be achieved.